

HAN ZHANG

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The Watson School of International and Public Affairs
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EMPLOYMENT • **Brown University**

Young Family Assistant Professor of Sociology and International and Public Affairs, 2025–present
Assistant Professor of Sociology and International and Public Affairs, 2024–2025

Jointly appointed in :

- Department of Sociology
- The Watson School of International and Public Affairs

Faculty Affiliate:

- Population Studies and Training Center
- Data Science Institute

On sabbatical (January–June 2027):

- Visiting Scholar, Stanford Center on China’s Economy and Institutions, Freeman Spogli Institute, Stanford University

• **The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology**

Assistant Professor
Division of Social Science
2020–2024

EDUCATION • **Princeton University**

Ph.D., Sociology, 2020
M.A., Sociology, 2018
Advisor: Matthew Salganik

• **Peking University**

B.S., Computer Science and B.A., History, 2013

EDITORIAL POSITIONS

- Editorial Board, *Sociological Methodology*, 2025–2027
- Editorial Board, *Chinese Sociological Review*, 2026–2029

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Digital surveillance; social movements; political sociology; authoritarian politics; computational social science; causal inference; experimental methods

PUBLICATIONS

^s Student collaborator; ^{*} Corresponding author

- **Han Zhang**. 2025. “Two-Layer Panopticon: How the Chinese Government Uses Digital Surveillance to Prevent Collective Action.” *Social Forces*: online first.
- **Han Zhang**^{*} and Ryan Leung^s. 2025. “Joint Text-and-Image Clustering for Social Science Research.” *Sociological Methodology*: online first.
- Jean Hong, Yong Kim, **Han Zhang**, and Tianzhu Qin^s. 2025. “Hug Fans or Follow Celebrities? How Nationalism Is Reinforced on Chinese Social Media.” *Science Advances* 11 (45): eadu8241.
– Media coverage: *South China Morning Post*.
- **Han Zhang**^{*}, Yao Lu, and Rui Bai^s. 2024. “Selection and Description Bias in Protest Reporting by Government and News Media on Weibo.” *The China Quarterly* 257: 75–99.
- Cheng, Linda^s, Yao Lu, and **Han Zhang**. 2024. “Gendered Erasure and Manufactured Passivity: Asymmetric Media Attention to Protests in China.” *Mobilization* 29 (3): 309–331.
- Liu, Larry^s, and **Han Zhang**. 2023. “Robots and Protest: Does Increased Protest among Chinese Workers Result in More Automation?” *Socio-Economic Review* 21 (3): 1751–1772.
- Wei, Lai^s, Elaine Yao^s, and **Han Zhang**^{*}. 2023. “Authoritarian Responsiveness and Political Attitudes during COVID-19: Evidence from Weibo and a Survey Experiment.” *Chinese Sociological Review* 55 (1): 1–37.
- **Han Zhang** and Yilang Peng. 2022. “Automated Image Clustering for Social Scientists: Review and Assessment of Performance.” *Sociological Methods & Research* 53 (3): 1534–1587.
- **Han Zhang** and Jennifer Pan. 2019. “CASM: A Deep-Learning Approach for Identifying Collective Action Events with Text and Image Data from Social Media.” *Sociological Methodology* 49 (1): 1–57.
– Media coverage: *Initium Media*; *Foreign Policy*.
- **Han Zhang**, Shawndra Hill, and David Rothschild. 2018. “Addressing Selection Bias in Event Studies with General Purpose Social Media Panels.” *Journal of Data and Information Quality* 10 (1): 1936–1955.

BOOK CHAPTER

- **Han Zhang**. 2023. “Analyzing Image Data with Machine Learning.” In *The Oxford Handbook of the Sociology of Machine Learning*, edited by Christian Borch and Juan Pablo Pardo-Guerra. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

REVISE & RESUBMIT

^s Student collaborator; ^{*} Corresponding author

- **Han Zhang**^{*} and Shu Wang^s. 2025. “Watching Big Brother: Quantifying Global Surveillance Camera Distributions from Street-View Images.” Revise and resubmit at *Sociological Methods & Research*.
- Zang, Emma, Yishi Yin^s, Zitong Wang, and **Han Zhang**. 2025. “From Extraction to Inference: Comparing Rule-Based, Machine Learning, and LLM Approaches for Classifying Social Outcomes in Legal Text.” Revise and resubmit at *Sociological Methods & Research*.

WORKING PAPERS AVAILABLE

^s Student collaborator; ^{*} Corresponding author

- **Han Zhang**^{*}. “How AI and Big Data Surveillance Differ in Preventing Collective Action.”
- **Han Zhang**^{*}, Yishi Yin^s, and Bing Tian. “How Should Researchers Construct Image Stimuli? A Framework for Constructing and Validating Image Stimuli.”
- **Han Zhang**^{*}, Jingchen Li^s, and Tianze Zhang^s. “Global Perception of White Privilege: Evidence from Millions of Product Images on E-Commerce Websites.”
- **Han Zhang**^{*} and Zhiyu Li^s. “From Events to Sequences: A Framework for Capturing Protest Dynamics.”
- Xinxin Wang^s, Haohan Chen, and **Han Zhang**^{*}. “Pandemic-Triggered Nationalism: Evidence from the COVID-19 Lockdown in China.”

WORK IN PROGRESS

^s Student collaborator

- “Mobilization Pathways: Is the Grievance-to-Protest Pipeline Universal?”
- “The Placement of Surveillance Cameras Relative to Police Stations and Government Offices in China.” (with Yuhua Wang and Charles Chang)
- “Surveillance Cameras, Disorder, and Neighborhood Perceptions in the United States.” (with Jackelyn Hwang)
- “Who Counts as Asian? The Racial Boundaries of Mixed-Race White-Asian Americans.” (with Emma Zang and Keitaro Okura)
- “Perceptions of Race and Class in Marriage Announcements.” (with Junbin Wu^s and Zhenchao Qian)

FUNDING

- PI, Humanities Research Funds, Brown University (internal), “Visualizing White Supremacy: A Global Analysis of Racial Representation in E-commerce” (2025). 5000 USD.
- PI, Hong Kong Research Grant Council, General Research Fund (No. 16602423), “Will More Surveillance Cameras Lead to Fewer Protests? A Global Level Analysis ” (2023–2024; ended upon relocation to Brown). 530,400 HKD.

- PI, Hong Kong Research Grant Council, Early Career Scheme (No. 26600321), “Whether and When Grievances Become Protests in China: A Big Data Approach” (2022–2024; ended upon relocation to Brown). 568,150 HKD.

AWARDS

- Best Paper Award, Computational Methods Division, International Communication Association, 2021.
- The Mayer Zald Best Graduate Student Paper Award, Section on Collective Behavior and Social Movements, American Sociological Association, 2016.

SERVICES

Departmental and University Service

- Campus Advisory Board, Data Science Institute, Brown University, 2025–
- Faculty Search Committee (Junior search in Sociology and Social Policy), Brown University, 2025–2026
- Colloquium Committee, Department of Sociology, Brown University, 2025–2026
- Mentor, Undergraduate Research Fellows, Population Studies and Training Center, Brown University, 2025–2026
- Faculty Search Committee, Division of Social Science, HKUST, 2023–2024
- Colloquium Committee, Division of Social Science, HKUST, 2022–2023
- Faculty Search Committee, Division of Social Science, HKUST, 2021–2022

Service to the Profession

- Discussant, American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, 2026
- Discussant, Digital Statecraft and Political Economy in China Conference, University of California, Berkeley, 2026
- Mentor, ASA Section on Mathematical Sociology mentoring program, 2026
- Mentor, FDS Workshop: AI for Social Science Research Methods, Yale University, 2026
- Member, PolMeth Poster Award Committee, 2023
- Co-host, first Hong Kong edition of the Summer Institutes in Computational Social Science (SICSS), 2021–2022. (https://sicss.io/2021/hong_kong/)
- Member, Best Graduate Student Paper Committee, ASA Section on Collective Behavior and Social Movements, 2017

TEACHING

- MPA 2479, *AI for Public Policy*, MPA, The Watson School of International and Public Affairs, Brown University, Fall 2026 (enrollment: ≈ 20)
- SOC 1100, *Introduction to Social Statistics*, Undergraduate, Brown University, Fall 2026 (enrollment: ≈ 100)
- SOC 1100, *Introduction to Social Statistics*, Undergraduate, Brown University, Spring 2026 (enrollment: 66)
- SOC 2961M, *Computational Methods for Social Scientists*, Graduate, Brown University, Spring 2026 (enrollment: 26)
- IAPA 1801X, *Surveillance: State, Capitalism, and Society*, Undergraduate, Brown University, Fall 2024 (enrollment: 10)
- SOSC 5340, *Econometric Approaches to Social Science Research*, PhD, HKUST, 2020–2023 (enrollment: ≈ 10)
- SOSC 4300/5500, *Computational Social Science*, Undergraduate/Graduate, HKUST, 2020–2023 (enrollment: ≈ 40)

ADVISING AND STUDENT SUPERVISION

Doctoral Committees

- Yitong Liu, Sociology, Brown University (Co-Chair), 2026–present
- Hsu Huang, Sociology, Brown University (Committee Member), 2024–present

Master's Theses

- Jingchen Li, Social Science (MPhil), HKUST (Chair), 2022–2024
- Pei Chen, Social Science (MPhil), HKUST (Chair), 2022–2024
- Chuyao Wang, Social Science (MPhil), HKUST (Chair), 2020–2022
 - Later completed a PhD at the London School of Economics and Political Science.

Undergraduate Honors Theses

- Emily Hong, Sociology, Brown University (Advisor), 2026
- Derin Aderaju, IAPA, Brown University (Advisor), 2025–2026
- Elliot Smith, IAPA, Brown University (Advisor), 2025–2026.
 - Thesis awarded the Richard C. Barker Thesis Prize for the best thesis on international relations or global policy.
 - Selected as a Schwarzman Scholar.
- Raima Islam, IAPA, Brown University (Reader), 2024–2025

Pre-doctoral Research Assistants

- Yishi Yin (now a PhD student in Sociology at Northwestern University), 2025–2026
- Shuohan Huang (now a PhD student in Operations Research at Hong Kong PolyU), 2023–2024

- Zhiyu Li (now a PhD student in Government at Harvard University), 2022–2024
- Yilin Zhu (now a PhD student in Sociology at UC San Diego), 2021–2022

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

- Research Intern, Microsoft Research (New York City) Summer 2015
Working with Dr. David Rothschild and Dr. Shawndra Hill.
- Research Intern, Microsoft Research (Asia) Summer 2014
Working with Dr. Xing Xie and Dr. Nicholas Yuan Jing.

CONFERENCE PRESENTA- TIONS

- UC San Diego, Young Scholars Conference (Fudan–UC Center on Contemporary China), 2026
- Yale, FDS Workshop: AI for Social Science Research Methods, 2026
- Penn, International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2), 2024
- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2018–2023, 2026
- American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, 2016–2026
- Society for Political Methodology Annual Meeting, 2018, 2021, 2023, 2024

INVITED TALKS

- Computational Social Science Laboratory, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, 2026
- Department of Sociology, NYU, 2025
- Department of Sociology, Zhejiang University, 2025
- Division of Social Science, The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, 2025
- Department of Sociology, The University of Hong Kong, 2025
- Department of Data Science and Big Data Analytics, Renmin University of China, 2023
- Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Macau, 2023
- MacMillan Center for International and Area Studies, Yale, 2022
- Department of Sociology, Peking University, 2022
- School of Journalism and Communication, Nanjing University, 2021
- Department of Media and Communication, City University of Hong Kong, 2020
- Department of Sociology, CUNY, 2018

**REVIEWER
FOR PEER-
REVIEWED
JOURNALS**

American Journal of Sociology, American Sociological Review, American Political Science Review, Social Forces, Comparative Political Studies, Sociological Methods & Research, Sociological Methodology, Political Analysis, The China Quarterly, Chinese Sociological Review, Sociological Focus, Sage Open, Mobilization, Social Science Computer Review, The IEEE International Conference on Data Mining (ICDM)